Richard Ballard rpb233, Josephine Kelly jnk56, Jason Choi jc3697, Orazio Petito opp2, Matthew Wilkens, Yian Yin
INFO 2950 - 204
Phase 1
September 22, 2026

Discussion Section: 204 / Jingruo Chen jc3564@cornell.edu

Shared Workspace:
https://github.com/rbllrd/info2950-204_project

Three Dataset Ideas:

1. Name (Link to the online source)
    a. Short description
    b. Short discussion of availability of data
    c. Short discussion of trustworthiness of data
2. Congress Bills, Fundraising (https://api.congress.gov/#/, https://api.open.fec.gov/developers/)
    a. The first(api.congress.gov) is a dataset that contains each member of Congress' cosponsorship in legislative sessions. It details bills, sponsors/cosponsors, policy areas, and actions. The second(api.open.fec.gov) is a dataset of Congress' fundraising background. It itemizes given contributions by candidate and committee, with contributor name, employer, and occupation.
    b. Both are free federal APIs that don't require scraping. Congress.gov requires a free API key allows 5,000 requests per hour; gives bills, amendments, summaries, members, committees, hearing, the Congressional record, nominations, CRS reports, treaties and House roll call votes (we would use the bill, member, and committee information). Open FEC also requires a free API key and allows for 1,000 requests per hour. The two datasets use different labels, so we would join through the common legislators. Hence, our observation unit would be the member-Congress. Congress.gov contains no financial data and the FEC doesn't contain legislative data; combined, we can ask whether the composition of a member's fundraising predicts their cosponsorship rate in a given policy area.
    c. Congress.gov is maintained by the Library of Congress and is the source for federal legislative data. FEC filings are legally mandated disclosures and carry penalties for misreporting, giving us confidence and trust to its data. There are limitations and concerns with this data, however. First, the FEC data only contains publicly disclosed contributions rather than the total amount of given money, meaning that some spending may not be documented. Second, employer
3. F1 Race Data, Weather/Regional information (https://openf1.org/docs/, https://open-meteo.com/en/docs/historical-weather-api)

    a. The first dataset includes historical F1 race data able to be filtered by driver, race, or date. We can compare different teams and individuals and how their lap times, their pit duration, and any other relevant podium-seeking information varies in correspondence with real time weather data from the Weather API.
    b. Via the OpenF1 API, we get access to car telemetry, lap times, race positions, pit stops, team radio, weather, race control, and championship standings from all races, teams, and racers. Access is limited to historical data, meaning the 2023 season onward. The main access limitation with the Open Meteo API is the spatial resolution, having grid cells ranging from 11 km to 25 km in size. Additionally, the reports are hourly and constructed from data 1950 and onward.
    c. OpenF1 is a free, community-run API, so its data is generally reliable for stats because it's a large community, but it isn't an official source of record. Veritably, OpenF1 is directly based on F1 timing/telemetry data making it suitable for academic-style preparatory work, which is our purpose. Open Meteo may lose some reliability in how its data is built off of reanalysis of various sources (weather stations, aircrafts, buoys, radar, etc.) rather than a point observation.
4. College Admissions circa COVID (collegescorecard.ed.gov/data, nces.ed.gov/ipeds)
    a. Official U.S. Department of Education site offering downloadable institution-level CSV files on college costs, admissions, enrollment, and outcomes, covering 1996-97 through 2025–26.
    b. Free and public dataset, separate yearly files let you grab exactly the pre/post-COVID range (2018–19 through 2021–22) directly.
    c. Very high, since it's a federal dataset compiled from mandatory institutional reporting (IPEDS, NSLDS, Treasury), covering over 6,000 schools with no self-selection bias.
    d. The federal ADM survey's raw scorecard admissions figures are drawn from applicant, admit, and enrollment counts, plus test-score submission rates by institution and year.
    e. Free and public via the NCES Data Center though building a clean multi-year table takes more manual setup than Scorecard's single-file download.
    f. Reliable overall since reporting is mandatory and audited, but NCES itself flagged the 2020–21 cycle as disrupted by COVID; the rows are accurate, just not directly comparable to normal years.

Questions for Reviewers: